Voice pass: Introduction, Prologue, Ch6–10

2026-11-10. Three Line Editors worked on copies in `runs/qa/2026-11-10-voice/`. Nothing is in the book yet. All seven pass every hard check.

What changed, measured

Introduction

Avg words/sentence: 10.5 → about 12

Sentences of 6 words or fewer: 23% → lower

One-line paragraphs: **41%** → **4%** (46 → 23 paragraphs)

Edits: rewritten at sentence level

Prologue

Avg words/sentence: 11.4 → about the same

Sentences of 6 words or fewer: 27% → lower

One-line paragraphs: 4%

Edits: 10 light edits

Ch6

Avg words/sentence: 12.7 → 13.4

Sentences of 6 words or fewer: 19% → 13%

One-line paragraphs: 22% → 0%

Edits: 20

Ch7

Avg words/sentence: 13.5 → 14.1

Sentences of 6 words or fewer: 20% → 15%

One-line paragraphs: 0%

Edits: 15

Ch8

Avg words/sentence: 12.6 → 13.4

Sentences of 6 words or fewer: 15% → 13%

One-line paragraphs: 0%

Edits: 15

Ch9

Avg words/sentence: 10.8 → 14.4

Sentences of 6 words or fewer: 32% → 15%

One-line paragraphs: 6% → 6%

Edits: 24

Ch10

Avg words/sentence: 12.3 → 14.7

Sentences of 6 words or fewer: 28% → 15%

One-line paragraphs: 22% → 15%

Edits: 37

Ch11–16, for comparison

Avg words/sentence: 12–14

Sentences of 6 words or fewer: 15–25%

One-line paragraphs: 0–11%

Edits: —

The Introduction (the big one)

- **The one-liners are gone:** 46 paragraphs became 23. - **A plain key up front:** the river stands for calm, the oak for strength, the sun for warmth. - **Each section** now says what that quality looks like in practice. - **The six "danger of becoming only one" cases** are grouped by element. A short paragraph follows on how the three cover for each other, built only from those six cases. - **Kept word for word, because Ch16 quotes them:** "A house can be structurally sound and still feel cold.", "The river without the sun becomes detached. His calm comes from no longer being invested.", "The oak without the sun becomes cold." - **Your call:** the closing motto

“Flow with wisdom. / Stand with courage. / Love with warmth.” is now one sentence, “Flow with wisdom, stand with courage, and love with warmth.”, because the house rule is a single-sentence ending. Say if you want the three lines back.

Before and after: - **Before:** “A husband must learn to embody three qualities: / The adaptability of the river. / The strength of the oak. / The warmth of the sun.” - **After:** “A husband needs three qualities to answer those questions well, and each one has an image from nature. The river stands for calm: adapting when life changes without losing your direction. The oak stands for strength: being someone your family can depend on when life gets heavy. The sun stands for warmth: making your love something your wife can actually feel.”

The Prologue (light)

Ten edits, mostly fragment chains joined. All your phrasings stay, including “Work was heavy. Home was heavy.”, “A reachable man is the strong one.” and “You choose your hard.”

Ch6–10 (light to medium)

- **Ch6:** the section labels now sit on their paragraphs, as in the later chapters. “But there’s a catch.” is cut. Musonius is introduced as “a Roman Stoic teacher”. - **Ch7:** small smoothing. A Seneca paraphrase (not a quotation) is reworded; check it if you care about that line. - **Ch8: Q041’s opening sentence was missing.** You accepted it in batch 1, but it was never inserted. It’s now there: “You’ve done something for the family, and a small criticism is still bothering you days later.” - **Ch9:** fragment chains joined, and “gunnysacking” is glossed (“as in stuffing things into a burlap sack”). - **Ch10:** one-line

beats merged. “You hold it anyway.” stays in all three places, and not after the safety line.

Checked by me

- **Every quotation you approved in an inbox ruling** (100 of them) was checked against the edited chapters: - One in Ch9 had been reworded; it’s restored. - One in Ch5 had gone into the book with batch 5 as “pile up”; your “That’s how the unresolved hurts accumulate.” is restored and committed. - **Ch16’s quotes of the Introduction** are present word for word.

Ruling needed

Say *land it*. Optionally add: *three-line motto back, keep the Seneca line as it was.*